



African German Youth Initiative – Innovation Fund

Manual for Local Subsidy Applicants

1st Call for Proposals

OCTOBER 2019

Supported and implemented by:



In cooperation with:



RESEAU AGYI
BENIN



As a federal enterprise, GIZ supports the German Government in achieving its objectives in the field of international cooperation for sustainable development.

Published by:

Deutsche Gesellschaft für
Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH

Registered offices
Bonn and Eschborn, Germany

Friedrich-Ebert-Allee 40
53113 Bonn, Germany
Phone: +49 228 44 60-0
Fax: +49 228 44 60-17 66

Dag-Hammarskjöld-Weg 1-5
65760 Eschborn
Phone: +49 61 96 79-0
Fax: +49 61 96 79-11 15

Author:

GFA Consulting Group GmbH, Hamburg, Germany



This project, assisted by the German Government, is being carried out by GFA Consulting Group GmbH on behalf of the Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH

Hamburg, 2019

TABLE OF CONTENTS

ABBREVIATIONS.....	III
1	CONTEXT 1
1.1	BACKGROUND 1
1.2	AGYI-IF OBJECTIVES..... 1
1.3	DURATION OF AGYI-IF AND NUMBER OF CALLS 1
1.4	AGYI COUNTRIES OF INTERVENTION 1
1.5	AGYI-IF ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE 2
2	ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR CALL FOR PROPOSALS..... 2
2.1	ELIGIBILITY OF THE APPLICANT 2
2.2	ELIGIBILITY OF COUNTRIES FOR IMPLEMENTATION..... 3
2.3	ELIGIBILITY OF ACTIONS AND RESPECTIVE BUDGET FRAME 3
2.4	ELIGIBILITY OF COSTS 4
2.5	ELIGIBILITY OF DURATION..... 4
3	APPLICATION PROCEDURE (WEB-BASED)..... 4
3.1	OVERVIEW OF APPLICATION PROCEDURE 4
3.2	SUPPORT FOR APPLICANTS 5
4	ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION 5
4.1	CONTACT AND APPLICATION DETAIL OF THE APPLICANT 5
4.2	APPLICANT DETAILS..... 5
4.3	MANAGEMENT AND ACCOUNTING OF THE APPLICANT..... 5
4.4	ANTI-CORRUPTION CONFIRMATION 6
4.5	NON-REGISTERED YOUTH GROUP USING A PARENT ORGANIZATION TO SUBMIT APPLICATION (IF RELEVANT) 6
4.6	ELIGIBLE ACTION 6
4.7	ONLINE APPLICATION FORM QUESTIONS 6
5	TECHNICAL INFORMATION 6
5.1	LOGICAL FRAMEWORK 6
5.2	WORK PLAN 6
5.3	PROJECT PROPOSAL..... 7
6	BUDGET 7
7	EVALUATION PROCEDURE..... 8
7.1	EVALUATION GRID 8
7.2	COUNTRY QUOTA AND PRIORITIZED LIST 8
8	CONTRACTING 9
8.1	VERIFICATION OF INFORMATION THROUGH LOCAL COORDINATOR..... 9
8.2	CONTRACT..... 9
8.3	MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT 9
8.4	PAYMENTS..... 9
8.5	REPORTING 9
LIST OF ANNEXES	10
ANNEX 1:	REQUIRED ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION 10
ANNEX 2:	LOGICAL FRAMEWORK 10
ANNEX 3:	BUDGET TEMPLATE..... 10
ANNEX 4:	WORK PLAN TEMPLATE 10
ANNEX 5:	PROJECT PROPOSAL TEMPLATE 10
ANNEX 6:	EVALUATION GRID 10
ANNEX 7:	GIZ STANDARD LOCAL SUBSIDY CONTRACT TEMPLATE 10

ANNEX 8:	NARRATIVE REPORT TEMPLATE	10
ANNEX 9:	CONDITIONS FOR COMMERCIAL AND LEGAL SUITABILITY OF RECIPIENTS – CHECKLIST	10
ANNEX 10:	SDG AND THE AU AGENDA 2063	10
ANNEX 11:	PRESENTATION FOR INFORMATION EVENTS	10

ABBREVIATIONS

AGYI	African German Youth Initiative
AGYI-IF	African-German Youth Initiative - Innovation Fund
AU	African Union
AUC	African Union Commission
CfP	Call for Proposals
EG	Engagement Global
EUR	Euro
HQ	Head Quarter
IO	Implementing Organization
MoM	Minutes of Meeting
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
OECD-DAC	Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development - Development Assistance Committee
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
TYC	Tanzanian Youth Coalition
WESSA	Wildlife and Environment Society of South Africa

1 CONTEXT

1.1 Background

In their Agenda 2063, the African Union (AU) Member States have set the goal of providing Africa's youth with better access to education, training, skills development, employment and economic opportunities as well as leisure and cultural activities.

Educationally sound youth exchange programs and volunteer services can enable young people to expand their personal horizons and acquire life and employment skills. Furthermore, youth exchanges in the context of education for sustainable development are linked to the goal of promoting social engagement of young people in order to give them the opportunity to participate in sustainable development processes. However, exchange between young people from Africa and Germany has often taken place against a background of structural and economic inequality. So far, there are only very few opportunities for young African people to gain experience through mobility programs or exchange programs and voluntary services in Germany or other African countries.

The African-German Youth Initiative (AGYI) is a joint initiative of the German Federal Government and African Union Commission (AUC) to improve youth exchange and mobility between African countries and Germany. The aim is to develop essential competencies and skills among young individuals from African countries and Germany by focussing on sustainable global development and strengthening the idea of 'global citizenship'.

1.2 AGYI-IF objectives

In 2017, the decision has been taken to establish an AGYI Innovation Fund (AGYI-IF) with the aim to directly reach young individuals and exchange practitioners in the pilot countries Benin, Ghana, South Africa, Tanzania, Togo. It shall support ideas and concepts for innovative exchange programs, exchange preparation and follow-up measures, alumni networks and community-based change projects initiated by the alumni. By implementing a diversity of projects, a source of innovation and learning for best practices which furthermore can prove the impact and necessity of exchange programs on the societal level can be created.

1.3 Duration of AGYI-IF and number of calls

The AGYI-IF will be implemented from October 2019 to October 2020. In that period, two calls for proposals (CfP) will be published:

- The first CfP is foreseen for the last quarter of 2019
- The second CfP is foreseen for the first quarter of 2020

The quick succession of the two CfPs is due to the limited overall timeframe.

1.4 AGYI countries of intervention

The AGYI-IF will be covering projects in the following countries:

- South Africa
- Tanzania
- Benin, also a hub for
 - Ghana
 - Togo

1.5 AGYI-IF organizational structure

The AGYI-IF is administered by the Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) in partnership with the African Union and implemented by GFA Consulting Group Germany (GFA) in accordance with GIZ rules.

The implementation of the AGYI-IF is supported by local organisations in each pilot country. These provide technical assistance to the applicants in the drafting of their proposals as well as in their implementation. They are the following with their nominated focal points:

- South Africa
 - WESSA – focal point: Mike Denison (mike.denison@wessa.co.za)
- Tanzania
 - TYC – focal point: George Kessy (george.kessy@tzyc.org)
- Benin, also a hub for Togo and Ghana:
 - GIZ AGYI Benin - focal point Fawaz Ayah (fawaz.ayah@giz.de)

For all financial and administrative matters, the GFA local coordinators are responsible. They are the following:

- South Africa
 - Jurie van Niekerk (jurie-van.niekerk@gfa-group.de)
- Tanzania
 - Joel Mwakitalu (joel.mwakitalu@gfa-group.de)
- Benin, also a hub for Ghana, and Togo
 - Jean-Marie Hougbo (jean-marie.hougbo@gfa-group.de)

2 ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR CALL FOR PROPOSALS

2.1 Eligibility of the applicant

Applicants have to be registered as a non-profit organization.

Non-registered youth groups have the possibility to apply under a “parent organization”, which is a registered organization submitting the non-registered youth group’s proposal and signs the funding contract with GFA. This makes the parent organization in all aspects responsible for the contract. Each applicant must further fulfil certain conditions for commercial and legal suitability as described in Annex 9 “Conditions for commercial and legal suitability of recipients – checklist”.

The applicant has to be resident in one of the eligible African countries. The applicant’s person in charge of the action must be in the country during the implementation of the action. The eligible countries are:

- Benin
- Ghana
- South Africa
- Tanzania
- Togo

A German organization cannot be an applicant. However, a German organization can be a partner for an eligible applicant. The contract will be signed with the eligible applicant.

The action must be implemented by youth between 14-35 years of age.

Eligible youth groups acting as applicant are the following:

- Registered alumni organization (from an African-German youth exchange program or African-German voluntary youth service program)

- Registered host or sending organization (from an African-German youth exchange program or African-German voluntary youth service program)
- Registered organization (alumni, sending/host organization) preparing a project in the context of the African-German youth exchange. In this case, a brief description of the project idea and the name of the African-German youth organization foreseen as future partner must be provided
- Registered parent organization for a non-registered alumni organization

Registered parent organizations can submit a number of applications for different non-registered youth groups with different action titles. Each application has to be submitted individually and will receive an allocated application number.

A registered parent organization can submit only one own application to be implemented by the organization itself. The eligibility criteria of the AGYI-IF have to be met.

2.2 Eligibility of countries for implementation

The applicant can carry out the action in the following countries:

- Benin
- Ghana
- South Africa
- Tanzania
- Togo
- Germany

2.3 Eligibility of actions and respective budget frame

The following funding lines are eligible for actions:

- Support of alumni structures/networks: Enable African alumni from German-African youth exchange programs to act as multipliers for youth exchange and youth voluntary services (African alumni from German-African youth exchange programs as providing sustainability of exchange programs in line with the SDG and the AU Agenda 2063)

Budget: EUR 2,000 - EUR 10,000

- Innovative exchange formats and approaches: Promotion of innovative and inclusive approaches of African-German or trilateral youth exchange for skills development in line with the SDG and AU Agenda 2063 (piloting new approaches in African-German/intra-African/in-country youth exchange and youth volunteering)

Budget: EUR 2,000 - EUR 15,000

- Community based actions: Promote innovative community-based change projects within the context of African-German youth exchange and voluntary youth services to implement AU Agenda 2063 and/or the SDGs

Budget: EUR 2,000 - EUR 10,000

In the application form, each applicant will be asked to select one eligible action which fits the proposal best. Please select only one, even if your action would also address another one or even two. If the applicant selects more than one, the proposal will be rejected.

The action will be regarded more favourably if it targets groups which are marginalized with regard to age, gender, class, ethnicity, language, education, disabilities.

2.4 Eligibility of costs

The details of the eligible costs are given in the budget template. In principle, the following costs may be included in the action's budget:

- Supplies, postage, telephone, bank fees, office rent (up to 50% of total costs allowed)
- Travel (up to 50% of total costs allowed)
- Workshops/trainings
- Visibility/advocacy action
- Personnel costs such as top-up payments and consultancies (up to 30% of the total costs allowed)
- Other costs such as publications, studies/research, translation/interpretation, monitoring

No lump-sum payments shall be made to the recipient (e.g. x % for administrative costs), since direct contributions must be documented in full, based on the presentation of the original vouchers as evidence of use of funds.

The budget cannot be used for co-financing project applications for programs of Engagement Global (ASA, ENSA, CHAT, wwB, Weltwärts).

2.5 Eligibility of duration

The maximum duration of the proposed action is 5 months.

3 APPLICATION PROCEDURE (WEB-BASED)

3.1 Overview of application procedure

The application to the AGYI-IF is web-based. The applicant will be able to choose between English and French as preferred language. There will be also a translation into Swahili available for orientation. However, all application documents and information have to be submitted in either French or English.

The administrative part has to be completed online while other documents have to be uploaded. The format for the required administrative information is attached in Annex 1 so that the applicant can collect the required information before entering information online.

The date and time of application will be automatically registered when the applicant clicks on the submit button. Applications submitted after the set deadline will not be accepted.

In the application form, some guiding comments are added and marked in *italic* font. All these comments should be removed in the final proposal before the applicant clicks on the submit button. These comments were included as help only.

When working on the proposal, we advise the applicant to start completing the logical framework, and then the work plan and the budget. The applicant will have to keep checking the three documents, making necessary adjustments in order to assure coherence. Only when the applicant has achieved this, he or she shall start writing the narrative project proposal. The documents have to be uploaded in Word format (logical framework, work plan, proposal) and in Excel format (budget).

While writing the proposal, the applicant should check the evaluation grid, to make sure that the evaluation criteria are well covered in the proposal (Annex 6).

The internet can be unreliable. Therefore, it is recommended to submit the application as early as possible, at least two or three days before the deadline, just to make sure that the applicant can submit the application.

In case of any questions, support is available from the implementing organizations (IOs) for proposal writing and the local coordinators for financial and administrative matters (please see contact details above).

The proposal evaluation process will start after the set submission deadline.

After submitting the complete proposal, the applicant will receive a message to the e-mail address provided, informing that the application has been well received.

Applicants will be informed on the status of their proposal via e-mail.

The short-listed applicants will be contacted by the local coordinator to set an appointment for a visit to the applicant's office to assess the information provided in the application. Based on a positive report, the applicant will be offered a contract.

3.2 Support for applicants

The applicants are invited to send their questions related to the application to either the IO for technical support or the local coordinators for administrative/budgetary support in the first two weeks after publication of the CfP. Replies will be issued up to the third week.

In addition, information events will be held and potential applicants will be invited to attend. Date, time and location will be published through the same channels as the CfP.

4 ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION

4.1 Contact and application detail of the applicant

In the online application form, applicants will be required to provide some standard information, for example organization name, legal status, address, etc. as well as in which country or countries the applicant wants to implement the project.

Kindly note that, as mentioned under chapter 2.1 "Eligibility of the applicant", only a registered organizations can be an applicant. Non-registered youth groups can apply under a registered parent organization that acts as applicant. In that case, the parent organization will be the contract holder in the event of selection.

4.2 Applicant details

Under applicant details, the applicant will be asked to upload a registration document, proving that the applicant (or parent organization) is a registered non-profit organization. The applicant will also be asked to provide information stated on the applicant's national ID card such as the name as it appears there, ID card number and address as listed on the national ID card. This information will be verified at a later stage.

4.3 Management and accounting of the applicant

This section contains a number of questions related to the management structure and accounting procedures of the applicant. The GFA local coordinator will verify the answers to these questions when visiting the applicant's offices in the event of successful shortlisting, that is, when the African Union has taken the final decision on the short-list of selected proposals.

Applicants have to demonstrate basic financial accounting systems, procedures and statements before entering into a contract.

4.4 Anti-corruption confirmation

The applicant will have to confirm a number of statements related to anti-corruption.

4.5 Non-registered youth group using a parent organization to submit application (if relevant)

In case of a non-registered youth group wanting to implement a project, the application must be submitted under a registered parent organization. In this case, the legal and personal details of the parent organization should be provided as listed in the online application form, just as the information pertaining to the non-registered youth organization.

4.6 Eligible action

In the section “Eligibility of actions” the applicant finds further details concerning this point.

4.7 Online application form questions

Some additional information is requested in the online application form which is aimed at improving the AGYI-IF program. This includes, for example, the question how the applicant heard about this call for proposals and what kind of support applicants received from IOs and GFA country coordinators in the process of preparing proposals. Please review the copy of the online application form in Annex 1 in order to collect all relevant information needed before completing the online form.

5 TECHNICAL INFORMATION

5.1 Logical framework

The purpose and reason for completing a logical framework is to assist applicants in submitting a coherent proposal. For this CfP, a simplified logical framework is required.

Only one result has to be identified that reflects the foreseen change that the action intends to achieve for the identified target group. Indicators will provide information on how this change for the target group can be measured. The source and means of verification specifies where this information can be found.

The activities should be necessary and sufficient to reach the result. Together with the assumptions, they will lead to achieving the result.

To assess if the result has been achieved, it is not sufficient, for example, to state that the target group received a training. At the level of the result, it has to be proven that the intended change for the target group was achieved. This can be done, for example, in the form of a survey among the target group.

More information related to completing the logical framework is given in the template.

The logical framework is a separate MS Word document that must be uploaded with the application. The logical framework template can be found in Annex 2.

5.2 Work plan

In the work plan, the applicant enters the result and activities of the logical framework, indicating in which month(s) each activity will be implemented. The name of one person who will be responsible for a certain activity should be listed. A number of people may be contributing to the implementation of an activity, but only one person should be responsible. A

document should serve as proof that a certain activity was actually implemented. This can be a report, a signed agreement, or whatever else is appropriate.

The applicant might have to conduct separate activities to monitor the indicator/s for the result of the logical framework. In the narrative reports, progress made towards meeting these indicators should be documented.

The work plan is a separate MS Word document that must be uploaded with the application. The work plan template can be found in Annex 4.

5.3 Project proposal

Based on the logical framework, the applicant should complete the project description in the MS Word template provided. The outline has 11 chapters, and for each chapter a maximum of half a page is allowed.

Each section of the template provides guidelines on what information is expected in the proposal – please pay attention to the guidelines.

The chapters for the project proposal are:

1. Logistics and timing
2. Background information
3. Expected result
4. Definition of the indicators and sources of verification
5. Activities linked to the expected result
6. Assumptions and risks
7. Methodology
8. Coherence
9. Expected sustainability (continuation after the end of the action)
10. Monitoring
11. Justification of budget

The project proposal template is in Annex 5. For further information on the SDG and the AU Agenda 2063, please refer to Annex 10.

6 BUDGET

Only the cost categories and the respective cost ceilings provided in the budget template are eligible project costs. All costs must be well justified with regard to their necessity for implementing the proposed action. The contracting authority reserves the right to remove costs from the budget if deemed not essential or not sufficiently justified for project implementation.

Applicants must use the MS Excel spreadsheet template provided. The budget must be submitted as an Excel file – not as a PDF document. Failure to do so will result in the rejection of the proposal due to administrative non-compliance.

The template contains various notes and information on how to complete it.

The applicant will notice that for some budget lines 50% ceilings are given, such as for

- Supplies, postage, telephone, bank fees, postage, bank fees, etc.
- Travel

The ceiling for personnel, i.e. top-up payments for the applicant and consultancies, is 30% of the total budget.

Each workshop or training should be listed separately with detailed budget lines. The workshops/training shall be named workshop/training 1, workshop/training 2 and so forth.

The applicant should also budget and specify any potential additional costs for monitoring of the indicators for the result.

The budget cannot be used for co-financing project applications for programs of Engagement Global (ASA, ENSA, CHAT, wwB, Weltwärts).

The costs must be provided in local currency and in Euros. Taking into account that currencies are fluctuating, the applicant contract will be signed in local currency. The EUR conversions are considered as indicative and for GFA use only. For the conversion of the local currency amount into EUR, please use the exchange rate of the European Commission InforEuro currency converter at

<http://ec.europa.eu/budg/inforeuro/index#!/converter>.

The budget template can be found in Annex 3.

7 EVALUATION PROCEDURE

7.1 Evaluation grid

The first step of the evaluation will be the administrative compliance check as listed in Annex 1. Only if all relevant questions have been completed and the supporting documentation (registration documents, logical framework, project work plan, budget, and proposal were submitted with the application in the requested format, the application will pass this stage. If any of the required documents, sections or information are incomplete or any of the supporting documents were not uploaded/submitted, the application will be rejected as administratively non-compliant at this stage and not considered for further evaluation.

7.2 Country quota and prioritized list

All proposals that have passed the administrative check will undergo the technical evaluation according to the evaluation grid. The technical proposal evaluation criteria are detailed in the evaluation grid (see Annex 6). The Evaluation grid's chapters follow the general criteria of the OECD-DAC where relevant to this call for proposals. They are relevance, effectiveness, sustainability with the addition of budget evaluation. The evaluation grid informs applicants about the criteria by which their proposal is evaluated. **Applicants should check the evaluation grid to make sure that their proposal meets the evaluation criteria as much as possible.** The applicants shall not fill in the evaluation grid – this will be done by the evaluators.

Based on the evaluation points achieved, a prioritized list will be established, with the best-rated proposal listed at the top, followed by the second best-rated proposal and so forth. In a first step, such a prioritized list will be created for Tanzania, South Africa and the cluster of countries with Benin together with Togo and Ghana. For Tanzania, South Africa and the Benin/Togo/Ghana cluster, a quota is set for a maximum of 4 of the best proposals to be listed for possible funding. These proposals must have passed the administrative check.

Once the quota is established, all remaining application proposals will be ranked competitively, irrespective of the applicant's country. This will result in a prioritized list from which applications will be selected for contracts. The cut-off line is created by the availability of funds. Below the cut-off line the applications are on the waiting list.

The selection of applications based on country quota and competitive procedure will be submitted to the African Union for final selection.

8 CONTRACTING

8.1 Verification of information through local coordinator

The next step is that the national coordinator will verify in the short-listed applicant's offices the information provided under Administrative Information. The verification will be based on the format in Annex 9.

Should the verification through the local coordinator show that the information provided was incorrect, the application will be taken off the short-list and the next application from the waiting list is moved to the short-list.

8.2 Contract

If the applicant passes the due diligence verification, a contract will be offered to the applicant organization (see Annex 7).

The winners of each call for proposals will be published on the AU website.

8.3 Modification of contract

Changes to the contract to extend the implementation period or to increase the budget are not possible.

8.4 Payments

Upon signature of contract, the applicant will receive an advance payment upon presentation of a payment request. When 80% of the advance is spent, the applicant submits a narrative interim report and a financial report with all required documentation. The contracting authority will decide how many instalments will be made based on the quality of the application and the work plan.

8.5 Reporting

The contracted recipient will have to prepare narrative reports to be submitted with the request for payment of instalments. In addition, a final report has to be drafted.

The reporting templates are attached in Annex 7 for financial reporting and Annex 8 for narrative reporting.

LIST OF ANNEXES

Annex 1:	Required administrative information
Annex 2:	Logical framework
Annex 3:	Budget template
Annex 4:	Work plan template
Annex 5:	Project proposal template
Annex 6:	Evaluation grid
Annex 7:	GIZ standard local subsidy contract template
Annex 8:	Narrative report template
Annex 9:	Conditions for commercial and legal suitability of recipients – checklist
Annex 10:	SDG and the AU Agenda 2063
Annex 11:	Presentation for information events